

Standard

LOAD SEARCH

Charlotte, NC →
Anywhere

Ontario, CA →
AZ

Filter by:

Nov 27, 2023 - Jan 11, 2024

V-Van

Mode

Tags

Rate

0 - 45000 lbs

0 - 53 ft

Comp

Rate	Book It Now	Pickup	Company	Equipment	O-City	O-St	O-DH	D-City
\$1,000		11/28	ARCHERHUB	V	Montclair	CA	6	Flagstaff
\$1,200		11/28	ARCHERHUB	V	Montclair	CA	6	Flagstaff
		11/27	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Chino	CA	5	Tolleson
		12/1	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Rancho Cucamonga	CA	9	Tolleson
		11/29	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Rancho Cucamonga	CA	9	Tolleson
		11/29	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Fontana	CA	17	Phoenix
		12/4	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Rialto	CA	18	Tolleson
		11/27	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Rancho Cucamonga	CA	9	Tolleson
		11/27	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Buena Park	CA	32	Phoenix
		11/27	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Buena Park	CA	32	Tolleson
		11/27	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Buena Park	CA	32	Tolleson
		11/30	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Redlands	CA	33	Phoenix
		11/28	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Rancho Cucamonga	CA	9	Tolleson
		11/27	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Redlands	CA	33	Phoenix
		11/27	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Redlands	CA	33	Phoenix
		11/27	RXO CAPACITY SOLU...	V	Redlands	CA	33	Phoenix

MODULE 6

Load Board Mastery

Search smart, screen fast,
call only the loads worth calling.

How load boards work, every search field and results column, deadhead circles and zone searches, reading load details and broker credit signals, posting trucks and alarms, a night-shift search routine — and a full practice board for Truck 12 in Joliet.

12

practice loads to
screen

4

real board screens

~6 hours

study + practice

1

practice truck, all
modules

How to use this module

Everything so far comes together on the load board: equipment (M2), geography and time (M3), hours (M4) and a set-up carrier (M5). This module teaches you to **turn a screen of 300 loads into 2 phone calls**.

Meet the practice truck

Truck 12 · Blue Line Transport (practice carrier)

53' dry van, **no air-ride** · empty in **Joliet, IL, Wed 7:30 AM CT** · driver Carlos, full daily clocks, 40 h left on his 70 · legal max cargo **44,500 lb** · carrier wants the **Southeast** · minimum **\$2.40 per total mile** (practice number) · no hazmat.

This is Mike's message from Module 0. You will use Truck 12 again in Modules 7–11.

Study rhythm (about 6 hours)

- **Session 1 (1.5 h):** how boards work, the search form, deadhead.
- **Session 2 (1.5 h):** results, load details, broker signals.
- **Session 3 (1 h):** posting, alarms, routine, backhauls.
- **Session 4 (2 h):** screen the practice board, then the drill and check.

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No subscription needed yet

You'll use a real board when an employer or carrier gives you a seat (Module 0). Until then, the practice board, real screenshots and DAT/Truckstop help pages are enough to learn the logic.

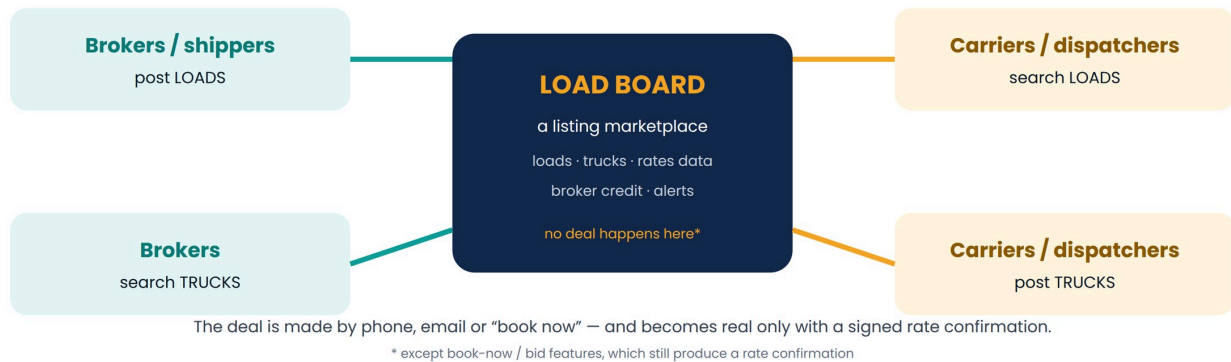
Three hundred loads. Which two do you call?

TRUCK DISPATCH FROM PAKISTAN · MODULE 6 · LOAD BOARD MASTERY

A marketplace, not a contract

How a load board works

Brokers advertise freight, carriers advertise trucks. The board connects them; it does not make the deal or guarantee payment.



Who uses load boards

- **Brokers** post loads they need trucks for, and search posted trucks.
- **Carriers and dispatchers** search loads and post available trucks.
- Boards add tools: **rate data, broker credit and days-to-pay**, reviews, alerts, "book now".

The biggest U.S. boards are **DAT** and **Truckstop**; others include 123Loadboard. Big brokers also run their own apps and portals.



A posting is not a promise

Postings can be old, already covered, missing details, or fake (Module 8). Rates can change on the phone.

Nothing is booked until the carrier signs a rate confirmation.



Access reminder (Module 0)

DAT lets carriers with authority add a **seat for their dispatcher**. Truckstop requires active carrier authority to search loads. Never borrow logins.

Where a carrier's loads come from

Source	How it works	Best for
Load boards	Search posted loads, call or email the broker, or book instantly where offered	New carriers; finding freight anywhere, fast
Truck postings	Post the empty truck; brokers call you	Thin markets; slow nights
Repeat brokers	Brokers you have hauled for email their lanes or call first	Better rates and trust over time
Broker apps / portals	Large brokers let set-up carriers book loads inside their own app	After the carrier is onboarded with that broker (Module 5)
Direct shippers	The carrier contracts with a shipper directly	Established carriers; not your first month

Four real boards, one logic

Real load-board screens (from your manuals)

Different boards, same logic. Interfaces change often — learn the columns, not the colours. Current DAT One looks different from these older screens.

DAT Power (older DAT interface)

From your OMNITECH manual. Columns: Age, Pickup, Truck, F/P, DH-O, Origin, Trip, Destination, Company, Contact, CS, DTP, Factor, Rate, Book.

DAT TruckersEdge (older)

Search chips at the top, results list, and a details panel on the right with credit score and days to pay.

123Loadboard

Another board: Age, Pickup, Trip, Rate and rate per mile, equipment, size/weight, company.

Truckstop

Rate, Book It Now, Pickup, Company, Equipment, O-City/O-DH, D-City/D-DH, Distance, Length, Weight, Last Updated.



Learn the columns, not the colours

Every board shows the same core facts: **age · pickup date · equipment · origin + deadhead · destination · trip miles · length/weight · company · credit/pay signals · rate**. Once you can read one, you can read them all, even after a redesign.

DAT One

The largest U.S. board. Broker **credit score** and **days to pay**, market rates (RateView), truck postings with alarms, TriHaul route suggestions (higher plans).

Truckstop

Needs active carrier authority to search. **Bond backing**, **RMIS** tags, **Book It Now** loads, rate insights and backhaul suggestions.

Others

123Loadboard (in your manual) and similar boards, plus brokers' own apps. Fewer loads on some, but the same columns and the same screening logic.

Features and plan names change often. Check the board's own site before telling a carrier what a plan includes; never quote prices from memory.

The search form

The search form, field by field

Recreation based on DAT One's help centre. Fill it from the truck's real situation — not from wishes.

1	Origin	Joliet, IL	Where your truck is or will be empty
2	DH-O	50	How far you'll drive empty to pickup (miles)
3	Destination	Z3 (or blank)	City, state, zone — blank = anywhere
4	DH-D	150	How far from the destination you accept
5	Load type	Full	Full, partial, or both
6	Equipment	Van (V)	Your truck type (Module 2)
7	Length	53 ft	Trailer length
8	Weight	44,500 lb	Max cargo your truck can legally take
9	Dates	Wed - Wed	When the truck can pick up

More filters

Search back — Only loads posted/refreshed in the last X hours

Company — Filter by a broker name

Tracking — Required / not required

Book / bid only — Loads you can book online without calling

Truck 12 today: 53' dry van, empty Wed 7:30 AM in Joliet, legal to 44,500 lb, carrier wants the Southeast.

DAT's definitions (help centre)

- **Origin** — “where your truck is or will be.”
- **DH-O** — “how far you are willing to drive to get a load.”
- **Destination** — city, state or zones; “leaving it blank is the equivalent to ‘anywhere’.”
- **Weight** — “the maximum cargo weight you can haul.”
- **Search back** — shows loads posted or refreshed in the last X hours.



Fill it from facts

Weight = the truck's confirmed legal max (Module 2). Dates = when the driver is really empty and legal (Module 4). Equipment = what the truck really is. A search built on wishes finds loads you can't haul.



Try it

Truck 12 prefers the Southeast. Which destination would you type: blank, “Charlotte, NC”, or “Z3, Z2”? What changes in the results? (Answer at the back.)

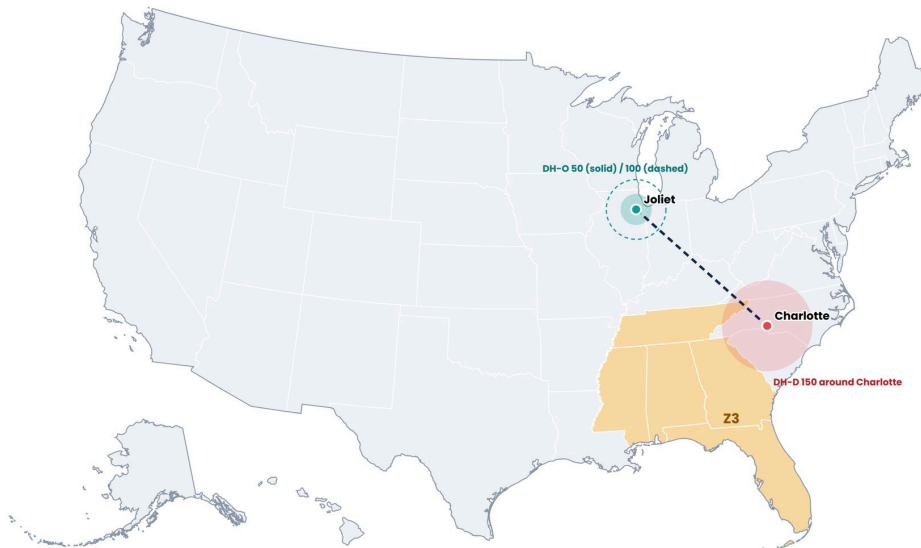
Five search mistakes beginners make

Mistake	What goes wrong
Weight left at the default	You see loads the truck can't legally carry and waste calls
Wrong date	Loads pick up before the driver is empty or legal to drive
“VR” or “any van” for a plain van	Reefer-only and special loads fill your screen
Huge DH-O from a big market	Hundreds of far-away loads bury the close ones
Search back of 24 h	You call on old postings that were covered hours ago

Deadhead circles and zones

Deadhead circles: what DH-O and DH-D really do

Map drawn for this course. Circles are to scale in straight-line miles; road miles are more.



DH-O (deadhead origin)

A circle around the truck: loads whose pickup is inside it appear. Bigger circle = more loads, but more unpaid miles.

DH-D (deadhead destination)

A circle around where you want to end up. Or search a whole zone (Z3 shaded).

Rule of thumb: start with DH-O 50–75 in busy freight areas, widen to 100–150 only if the board is thin. Every empty mile costs the carrier money (Module 7).

Choosing the circle size

Situation	DH-O
Big freight market (Chicago, Dallas, Atlanta)	25–75 mi
Medium city, decent freight	75–100 mi
Rural area / thin board	100–150+ mi

Practice guidelines, not rules. The carrier decides how much deadhead it accepts.



Deadhead is unpaid but not free

Every empty mile costs fuel, driver pay, tyres and hours (Module 4). A load 90 miles away uses nearly 2 hours of the driver's clock before loading even starts.



Zones

A destination of **Z3** covers AL, FL, GA, MS and TN in one search (Module 3). Type several: **Z3, Z2**.

The results screen

A practice load board

Recreated for this course with fictional brokers and practice data. Columns follow a typical DAT-style results screen.

PRACTICE LOAD BOARD — Search: Joliet, IL (DH-O 50) → Anywhere · V · Full · 53 ft · 44,500 lb · Wed														12 results
Age	Pickup	Truck	F/P	DH-O	Origin	Trip	Destination	DH-D	Company	CS	DTP	Len	Weight	Rate
0:12	Wed	V	F	(40)	Chicago, IL	760	Charlotte, NC	(0)	Lakeshore Logistics	96	28	53 ft	42,000	\$2,050
0:25	Wed	V	F	(12)	Bolingbrook, IL	715	Atlanta, GA	(0)	Peachtree Freight	92	33	53 ft	38,500	\$1,600
0:40	Wed	V	F	(0)	Joliet, IL	1370	Miami, FL	(0)	Coastline Brokerage	88	35	53 ft	43,000	\$3,200
0:08	Wed	R	F	(45)	Elgin, IL	480	Nashville, TN	(0)	Northstar Cold Chain	95	26	53 ft	40,000	\$1,450
1:05	Wed	V	F	(25)	Aurora, IL	540	Memphis, TN	(0)	Delta Route Logistics	90	31	53 ft	46,500	\$1,500
0:18	Wed	V	F	(8)	Romeoville, IL	745	Charlotte, NC	(0)	Quickline Transport Brokers	71	58	53 ft	40,000	—
0:33	Wed	V	F	(35)	Kankakee, IL	1050	Jacksonville, FL	(0)	Harbor Point Logistics	94	30	53 ft	36,000	\$2,700
0:15	Thu	V	F	(40)	Gary, IN	700	Atlanta, GA	(0)	Midwest Freight Partners	93	29	53 ft	41,000	\$1,950
0:50	Wed	V	P	(20)	Naperville, IL	355	Columbus, OH	(0)	Buckeye Shipping Group	89	34	20 ft	12,000	\$900
4:30	Wed	V	F	(0)	Joliet, IL	780	Greenville, SC	(0)	Prime Direct Freight LLC	—	—	53 ft	42,000	\$2,300
0:22	Wed	VA	F	(40)	Chicago, IL	660	Birmingham, AL	(0)	Magnolia Freight Co	91	32	53 ft	39,000	\$1,750
0:10	Wed	V	F	(10)	Plainfield, IL	760	Charlotte, NC	(0)	Carolina Link Logistics	97	27	53 ft	44,000	\$1,980

CS = broker credit score · DTP = average days to pay · (DH-O) = empty miles from your search origin to pickup · — = not provided (call to ask).

Read every column

Thirteen columns, one decision. Learn what each one tells you before you pick up the phone.

Age	How long since posted/refreshed. Old postings are often already covered.	Pickup	Date the load is ready. Must match when your truck is empty.
Truck	Equipment required: V, R, F, VA... (Module 2).	F/P	Full or partial load.
DH-O	Empty miles from your search city to the pickup.	Origin / Destination	City, ST — read them like a lane (Module 3).
Trip	Loaded miles from pickup to delivery.	DH-D	Distance from your desired destination (when you search to a city).
Company	The broker (or shipper). Click for phone, MC, reviews.	CS	DAT credit score, built from days-to-pay trends and other credit data. Higher is better.
DTP	Average days the broker takes to pay after receiving paperwork.	Length / Weight	Trailer length needed and cargo weight: compare with your truck's max.
Rate	Posted total pay. Often blank — call to get it.		

Open a load before you call

Open the load: the details panel

Label names follow DAT One's "Understanding load details" help page. Practice data; MC hidden.

Chicago, IL → Charlotte, NC • Load details (practice)	
LOAD	
Trip	760 mi ¹
Origin	Chicago, IL (40) ²
Date	Wed • PU 10:00–14:00 ²
Load / Truck	Full • Van • 53 ft ³
Weight	42,000 lb ³
Commodity	Paper products ³
Reference ID	LL-448210 ⁴
RATE	
Rate (total)	\$2,050 ⁵
Rate / mile	\$2.70 ⁵
Market rates	Spot / contract ranges shown ⁶
COMPANY	
Company	Lakeshore Logistics ⁷
Phone • MC	(312) 555-0199 • MC 000000 ⁷
Reviews	★★★★☆ (212) ⁸
Credit score	96 ⁸
Days to pay	28 ⁸

- 1 Trip miles** — Loaded miles — use them for RPM and HOS.
- 2 Origin + date** — Where and when. The (40) is deadhead from your search city.
- 3 Load facts** — Equipment, length, weight, commodity; the Module 2 fit check.
- 4 Reference ID** — Quote it when you call: "I'm calling on load LL-448210."
- 5 Rate + RPM** — Posted total and per loaded mile. Deadhead is not included.
- 6 Market rates** — What similar loads paid recently (Module 7).
- 7 Contact** — Call the number, and check the MC matches FMCSA records (Module 8).
- 8 Broker quality** — Reviews, credit score and days-to-pay signal whether and how fast the broker pays.

The 20-second pre-call check

- Fit:** equipment, length, weight, commodity.
- Time:** pickup window vs truck availability; delivery if shown.
- Lane:** direction, zones, next-load market.
- Money:** posted rate ÷ total miles vs carrier minimum.
- Broker:** credit score, days to pay, reviews, MC.



Say it out loud — drill 8: the first 15 seconds

"Hi, this is Jawad with Blue Line Transport, MC 1298456. I'm calling about your load LL-448210, Chicago to Charlotte, picking up Wednesday. Is it still available?"

If yes: **"Great. What's the commodity and weight, and what are the pickup and delivery appointments?"** Rate comes after the facts (Module 8).

Will this broker pay — and how fast?

DAT signals

Signal	What it means
Credit score (CS)	DAT's credit rating for the company, calculated with Equifax from days-to-pay trends, collections, bankruptcy alerts and other data. Higher is better; new brokers may have no score.
Days to pay (DTP)	Average days the company takes to pay invoices. Around 30 is normal; 45–60+ is slow.
Reviews	Star ratings from carriers.

Truckstop signals

Signal	What it means
Bond backing	Shows the broker's surety bond status
RMIS verification	Broker uses RMIS onboarding
Factorable / new / private	Load tags: can the carrier's factor buy this invoice?
Rate insights	Pricing context before you call

Rate	Book It Now	Pickup	Company	Equipment	O-City	O-St	O-DH	D-City	D-St	D-DH	Distance	Length	Weight
\$1,000		11/08	ARCHEBUSH	V	Montclair	CA	6	Flagstaff	AZ		435	0	441
\$1,200		11/08	ARCHEBUSH	V	Montclair	CA	6	Flagstaff	AZ		435	0	441
		11/07	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	China	CA	5	Tolleson	AZ		326	53	416
		12/1	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Rancho Cucamonga	CA	9	Tolleson	AZ		330	53	442
		11/09	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Rancho Cucamonga	CA	9	Tolleson	AZ		330	53	442
		11/09	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Fontana	CA	17	Phoenix	AZ		328	53	
		12/4	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Rialto	CA	16	Tolleson	AZ		313	53	124
		11/07	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Rancho Cucamonga	CA	9	Tolleson	AZ		330	53	415
		11/07	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Buena Park	CA	32	Phoenix	AZ		362	53	173
		11/07	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Buena Park	CA	32	Tolleson	AZ		350	53	73
		11/07	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Buena Park	CA	32	Tolleson	AZ		350	53	131
		11/30	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Redlands	CA	33	Phoenix	AZ		312	53	
		11/08	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Rancho Cucamonga	CA	9	Tolleson	AZ		330	53	402
		11/09	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Redlands	CA	33	Phoenix	AZ		312	53	
		11/07	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Redlands	CA	33	Phoenix	AZ		312	53	
		11/09	RKO CARGITY SOU...	V	Redlands	CA	33	Phoenix	AZ		312	53	

Real Truckstop search (your manual): Charlotte → anywhere and Ontario, CA → AZ, with rate, Book It Now, company, O-DH/D-DH, distance and weight columns.



Ask your factoring company

If the carrier factors, the factor may refuse to buy invoices from low-credit brokers. Many factors offer a **broker credit check**. Check it before booking a load from an unfamiliar broker.



Signals are not verification

A good score doesn't prove the person on the phone really works for that broker. Identity theft and double brokering are covered in Module 8.

Posting trucks and alarms

Post the truck, set the alarm

Searching finds posted loads; posting lets brokers with unposted freight find you. Do both.

Truck posting (practice)	
Origin	Joliet, IL
Destination	Z3, Z2 (Southeast)
Available	Wed 07:30 CT
Load type	Full
Equipment	Van (V) · 53 ft
Weight	44,500 lb
Contact	Your phone / email

Why post? DAT: posting puts your truck “in front of thousands of brokers’ and shippers’ eyes.” Brokers searching for trucks call you.

Alarms / alerts On DAT One, turning on the bell on a truck posting plays a sound and counts new matching loads. Saved searches can also send email alerts.

Be specific and true. Wrong availability or equipment wastes brokers’ time and hurts the carrier’s name.

Remove the posting as soon as the truck is booked — otherwise you get calls for a truck that isn’t there.

When to post

- As soon as you know when and where the truck will be empty, ideally the day before.
- Post each truck separately with its real details.
- Update the posting if the time or location changes; remove it when booked.



What happens next

Brokers searching for trucks see your posting and call or email. Be ready to answer: the truck’s location, availability, equipment, and a rate. Keep the carrier’s minimum in mind (Module 7).



When a broker calls about your posting

“Blue Line Transport, this is Jawad.” Broker: “I see your truck in Joliet. I have a load to Atlanta.”
“Sure. What’s the pickup location and time, the delivery appointment, the commodity and weight?” Then: **“What are you paying on it?”** If it works, get the load details in writing before committing.

	Searching loads	Posting trucks
Who calls	You call the broker	The broker calls you
Speed	Fast when the board is busy	Slower; works while you do other things
Use it when	Always, first	Thin markets, odd equipment, late nights, and always as a backup

A search routine and good habits

A search routine for your night shift (Pakistan time, U.S. summer)

Discipline beats random scrolling. Example routine — adjust to your fleet.

4:30 PM	Plan	List trucks emptying today/tomorrow: location, time, hours, preferences.
5:00 PM	Post + save	Post each truck; save one search per truck; turn on alarms.
5:15 PM	First sweep	Search back 2–3 h; sort by pickup/age; shortlist fresh loads.
5:30–8 PM	Call window	East Coast brokers busiest now. Call the shortlist fast — good loads go in minutes.
Every 15–20 min	Refresh	New postings appear constantly; alarms help.
Late shift	West + next day	West Coast freight; tomorrow's loads; widen DH or zones if thin.

Habit	Why
One saved search per truck	Refresh with one click; alarms work per search or posting
Short search-back (2–4 h)	Old postings are often covered; fresh ones get answered
Sort by age or pickup	See new loads first; don't scroll randomly
Blank destination, then zones	See everything, then narrow to the carrier's preferred regions
Note every call	Load ID, broker, contact, offer, answer: you will call again
Widen slowly	Increase DH-O or zones only if the board is thin



Your clock vs their clock

When it is **8:00 AM in Chicago (CT)**, it is **6:00 PM in Pakistan** during U.S. daylight time (March–November) and **7:00 PM** in winter. Many brokers post fresh loads at the start of their business day, so the first two hours of your shift matter most.



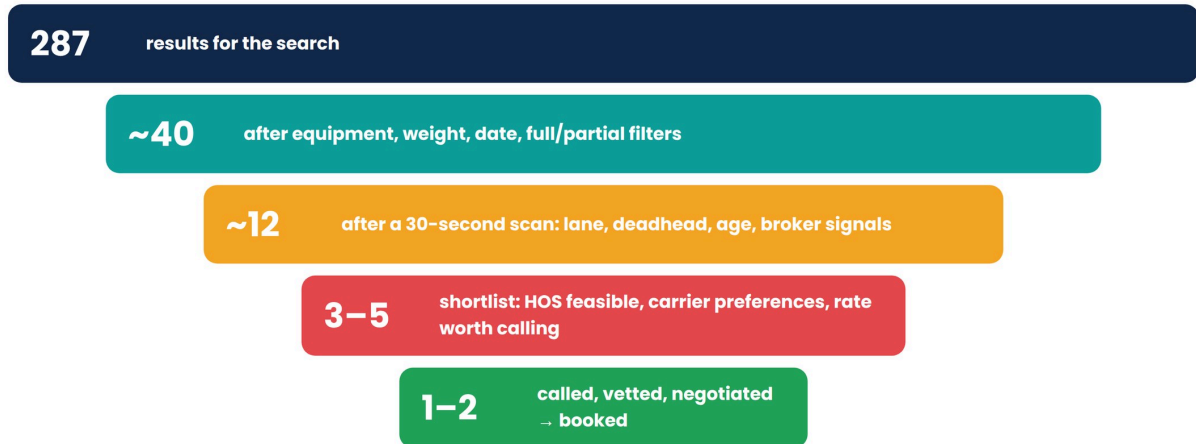
Friday rule of thumb

On Friday, brokers post loads for Monday pickup. If a truck will be empty over the weekend, search Monday pickups on Friday and ask the carrier if the driver is taking a weekend break.

The funnel: screen fast, call few

The search funnel

Professional dispatchers screen fast and call few. Numbers are an example from a busy area.



The five-filter scan (per load, ~10 seconds)

1. **Can we haul it?** Equipment, weight, length, hazmat.
2. **Can we get there?** Deadhead, pickup date and time, hours.
3. **Can we deliver it?** Appointment feasible (Module 4).
4. **Does it go somewhere good?** Lane, carrier preference, next load.
5. **Is it worth calling?** Rate per total mile, broker signals.



Call in order

Call the best load first, but have the second and third ready. If the first is gone, you lose seconds, not the evening.

Worked example: three loads through the five filters

Filter	Load 1 • Chicago → Charlotte	Load 5 • Aurora → Memphis	Load 11 • Chicago → Birmingham
1 Haul it?	V, 53 ft, 42,000 lb OK	46,500 lb > 44,500 STOP	VA = air-ride required STOP
2 Get there?	40 mi DH, Wed OK	—	—
3 Deliver it?	Thu FCFS 8–4 ET OK	—	—
4 Good lane?	Southeast OK	—	—
5 Worth calling?	\$2.56/total mi, CS 96 CALL	—	—

Stop at the first failed filter. Two of these three loads take two seconds each.

Backhauls and triangles

Backhauls and triangles

Plan the week, not just the load. Map drawn for this course; legs illustrative.



Backhaul = the load that brings the truck back toward home or its next good market.

Triangle routing: instead of there-and-back, three legs through good markets can mean fewer empty miles. DAT One Pro's TriHaul tool suggests triangles; Truckstop highlights backhauls.

Search the next leg before you book the first. Search Charlotte → Z3/Z4/Z6 for Thursday; if nothing decent exists, the Charlotte load is worth less than it looks.

Search the next leg first

Before booking Joliet → Charlotte, run a quick search: **Charlotte (DH-O 75) → Z4, Z6** for Thursday or Friday. Many decent loads back toward the Midwest means the truck is well placed. Few or cheap loads means you should value the outbound load lower, or pick a different destination.



Tools that help

DAT's guide describes **TriHaul** (DAT One Pro), which suggests triangular routes to reduce deadhead. Truckstop highlights backhauls to reduce deadhead. Rate history tools (DAT RateView) come in Module 7.

Headhaul, backhaul, triangle

Term	Meaning	For Truck 12
Headhaul	A lane with lots of freight and fewer trucks: rates are usually stronger	Depends on the market that week: check, don't assume
Backhaul	The return direction, often with more trucks than loads: rates are usually weaker	A load back toward Joliet after the Southeast run
Triangle	Three legs instead of an out-and-back, to avoid a weak return lane	Joliet → Charlotte → Atlanta → Midwest



Try it

Truck 12 books Load 7 to Jacksonville, FL. Write the next search. (Suggested: origin Jacksonville, DH-O 75, destination Z4, Z6 or blank, van, full, 53 ft, 44,500 lb, delivery day + 1. Check the load count before booking the outbound leg.)

Screen the Truck 12 board

Truck 12: 53’ dry van, **no air-ride**, empty **Joliet Wed 7:30 AM CT**, max **44,500 lb**, Southeast preferred, minimum **\$2.40 per total mile**, no hazmat. For each load decide: CALL

CALL WITH A PLAN REJECT , with a one-line reason.

A practice load board

Recreated for this course with fictional brokers and practice data. Columns follow a typical DAT-style results screen.

PRACTICE LOAD BOARD — Search: Joliet, IL (DH-O 50) → Anywhere · V · Full · 53 ft · 44,500 lb · Wed														12 results
Age	Pickup	Truck	F/P	DH-O	Origin	Trip	Destination	DH-D	Company	CS	DTP	Len	Weight	Rate
0:12	Wed	V	F	(40)	Chicago, IL	760	Charlotte, NC	(0)	Lakeshore Logistics	96	28	53 ft	42,000	\$2,050
0:25	Wed	V	F	(12)	Bolingbrook, IL	715	Atlanta, GA	(0)	Peachtree Freight	92	33	53 ft	38,500	\$1,600
0:40	Wed	V	F	(0)	Joliet, IL	1370	Miami, FL	(0)	Coastline Brokerage	88	35	53 ft	43,000	\$3,200
0:08	Wed	R	F	(45)	Elgin, IL	480	Nashville, TN	(0)	Northstar Cold Chain	95	26	53 ft	40,000	\$1,450
1:05	Wed	V	F	(25)	Aurora, IL	540	Memphis, TN	(0)	Delta Route Logistics	90	31	53 ft	46,500	\$1,500
0:18	Wed	V	F	(8)	Romeoville, IL	745	Charlotte, NC	(0)	Quickline Transport Brokers	71	58	53 ft	40,000	—
0:33	Wed	V	F	(35)	Kankakee, IL	1050	Jacksonville, FL	(0)	Harbor Point Logistics	94	30	53 ft	36,000	\$2,700
0:15	Thu	V	F	(40)	Gary, IN	700	Atlanta, GA	(0)	Midwest Freight Partners	93	29	53 ft	41,000	\$1,950
0:50	Wed	V	P	(20)	Naperville, IL	355	Columbus, OH	(0)	Buckeye Shipping Group	89	34	20 ft	12,000	\$900
4:30	Wed	V	F	(0)	Joliet, IL	780	Greenville, SC	(0)	Prime Direct Freight LLC	—	—	53 ft	42,000	\$2,300
0:22	Wed	VA	F	(40)	Chicago, IL	660	Birmingham, AL	(0)	Magnolia Freight Co	91	32	53 ft	39,000	\$1,750
0:10	Wed	V	F	(10)	Plainfield, IL	760	Charlotte, NC	(0)	Carolina Link Logistics	97	27	53 ft	44,000	\$1,980

CS = broker credit score · DTP = average days to pay · (DH-O) = empty miles from your search origin to pickup · — = not provided (call to ask).

Extra facts you learn when you open the loads

Load 12: delivery **Thu 8:00 AM ET** in Charlotte. Load 10: the company was registered **3 weeks ago**, no reviews. Load 11: comments say “air-ride required.” Load 1: delivery Thu, FCFS 8 AM–4 PM ET.

#	Decision	Reason	#	Decision	Reason
1			7		
2			8		
3			9		
4			10		
5			11		
6			12		

Screening result

After screening: 2 strong, 2 maybe, 8 out

Green = call first. Amber = call with a plan (negotiate / check credit). Faded = rejected — the reasons are on the next page.

PRACTICE LOAD BOARD — Search: Joliet, IL (DH-O 50) → Anywhere • V • Full • 53 ft • 44,500 lb • Wed														12 results
Age	Pickup	Truck	F/P	DH-O	Origin	Trip	Destination	DH-D	Company	CS	DTP	Len	Weight	Rate
0:12	Wed	V	F	(40)	Chicago, IL	760	Charlotte, NC	(0)	Lakeshore Logistics	96	28	53 ft	42,000	\$2,050
0:25	Wed	V	F	(12)	Bolingbrook, IL	715	Atlanta, GA	(0)	Peachtree Freight	92	33	53 ft	38,500	\$1,600
0:40	Wed	V	F	(0)	Joliet, IL	1370	Miami, FL	(0)	Coastline Brokerage	88	35	53 ft	43,000	\$3,200
0:08	Wed	R	F	(45)	Elgin, IL	480	Nashville, TN	(0)	Northstar Cold Chain	95	26	53 ft	40,000	\$1,450
1:05	Wed	V	F	(25)	Aurora, IL	540	Memphis, TN	(0)	Delta Route Logistics	90	31	53 ft	46,500	\$1,500
0:18	Wed	V	F	(8)	Romeoville, IL	745	Charlotte, NC	(0)	Quickline Transport Brokers	71	58	53 ft	40,000	—
0:33	Wed	V	F	(35)	Kankakee, IL	1050	Jacksonville, FL	(0)	Harbor Point Logistics	94	30	53 ft	36,000	\$2,700
0:15	Thu	V	F	(40)	Gary, IN	700	Atlanta, GA	(0)	Midwest Freight Partners	93	29	53 ft	41,000	\$1,950
0:50	Wed	V	P	(20)	Naperville, IL	355	Columbus, OH	(0)	Buckeye Shipping Group	89	34	20 ft	12,000	\$900
4:30	Wed	V	F	(0)	Joliet, IL	780	Greenville, SC	(0)	Prime Direct Freight LLC	—	—	53 ft	42,000	\$2,300
0:22	Wed	VA	F	(40)	Chicago, IL	660	Birmingham, AL	(0)	Magnolia Freight Co	91	32	53 ft	39,000	\$1,750
0:10	Wed	V	F	(10)	Plainfield, IL	760	Charlotte, NC	(0)	Carolina Link Logistics	97	27	53 ft	44,000	\$1,980

#	Decision	Reason
1	CALL	Fits; Southeast; $\$2,050 \div 800$ total mi = \$2.56 ; strong broker (96/28); FCFS delivery Thu gives buffer (Module 4)
7	CALL	Fits; Southeast; $\$2,700 \div 1,085$ = \$2.49 ; good broker; about 2 driving days, so check delivery time
2	PLAN	Good lane, but $\$1,600 \div 727$ = \$2.20. Negotiate to at least \$1,745 ($727 \times \2.40)
6	PLAN	Good lane, no rate posted; CS 71, DTP 58 = slow payer. Ask the rate; check with the factor/carrier before booking
3	REJECT	\$2.34 per mile, below minimum; 1,370 mi into Miami, a weak reload area
4	REJECT	Reefer (R) required, and our truck is a dry van
5	REJECT	46,500 lb, over the truck's 44,500 lb max
8	REJECT*	Pickup Thursday: the truck would sit a day. *Keep as backup if nothing else works
9	REJECT	Partial, short, to Ohio: not the Southeast; small total pay
10	REJECT	Posted 4.5 h ago; brand-new broker with no credit or reviews; rate well above others. Probably covered, and a fraud red flag (Module 8)
11	REJECT	Air-ride (VA) required; our truck doesn't have it
12	REJECT	Delivery Thu 8 AM ET is impossible from a Wed pickup ~760 mi away (Module 4). Ask for a later delivery, otherwise pass

The math behind the shortlist

Quick math: rate per mile, loaded vs all miles

The board shows rate ÷ loaded miles. Your carrier pays for every mile, including deadhead. Carrier minimum here: \$2.40 per total mile (practice).

Load	Rate	Loaded mi	Board RPM	Deadhead	Total mi	RPM all miles
Load 1 · Chicago → Charlotte	\$2,050	760	\$2.70	40	800	\$2.56
Load 2 · Bolingbrook → Atlanta	\$1,600	715	\$2.24	12	727	\$2.20
Load 3 · Joliet → Miami	\$3,200	1370	\$2.34	0	1370	\$2.34
Load 7 · Kankakee → Jacksonville	\$2,700	1050	\$2.57	35	1085	\$2.49

Load 3 pays the most in total, but below \$2.40 per mile, and ends in Miami (Module 3: think one load ahead).

Module 7 goes deeper: the carrier's real cost per mile, market rates, and next-load value.

Build three searches

Write the search form (origin, DH-O, destination, DH-D, equipment, load type, length, weight, dates) for each truck. Answers at the back.

#	Truck and situation
A	26' box truck with liftgate, empty in Newark, NJ, tomorrow 8 AM ET, max 9,000 lb, wants to stay in the Northeast
B	53' reefer, empty in Salinas, CA, Friday, max 43,000 lb, wants to head east toward Texas
C	48' flatbed with tarps and chains, empty in Birmingham, AL, today, max 46,000 lb, anywhere in the Southeast

Quick rate-per-mile drill

#	Posted load	Rate / total mile	Vs \$2.40
D	\$1,400 · 520 loaded mi · 30 mi deadhead		
E	\$2,900 · 1,150 loaded mi · 60 mi deadhead		
F	\$650 · 210 loaded mi · 55 mi deadhead		

load
Answers: D \$2.55 above · E \$2.397, a hair under: ask for \$2,904 or more · F \$2.45 above, but only \$650 for the day: check the next

Module 6 check

1. Why is a load board posting not a booking?
2. What do DH-O and DH-D mean? What happens if you set DH-O too high?
3. What does a blank destination mean? How would you search the whole Southeast in one go?
4. What does the “Age” column tell you, and why do fresh loads matter?
5. What does DAT’s credit score measure? What is DTP?
6. A load shows \$1,800 for 700 loaded miles; the truck is 50 miles away. What is the rate per total mile?
7. Why post a truck as well as searching?
8. What should you do with a truck posting when the truck gets booked?
9. List the five-filter scan.
10. Why search the next leg before booking the first load?
11. Name three signals Truckstop shows about brokers or loads.
12. A broker with no credit history posts a rate much higher than others. What do you think, and what do you do?



Speaking practice

Call-script practice: read drill 8 (page 9) for loads 1, 7 and 2 from the practice board, changing the reference ID, lane and pickup day each time.

Skills self-check: tick when you can do it without notes

Skill	Can do	Need practice
Fill a search form from a carrier’s truck details	☐	☐
Pick a sensible DH-O and destination (city, state or zones)	☐	☐
Read every column of a results screen	☐	☐
Calculate rate per total mile in your head, within 5 cents	☐	☐
Read credit score, days to pay and red flags	☐	☐
Screen 12 loads down to 2 calls in under 5 minutes	☐	☐
Say drill 8 clearly in under 15 seconds	☐	☐

Answers

- p.6** Blank = all destinations: most results, including bad lanes. "Charlotte, NC" = only near Charlotte (DH-D). "Z3, Z2" = the whole Southeast (AL, FL, GA, MS, TN, MD, NC, SC, VA, WV). Best for this carrier's preference.
- 1** It is only an advertisement. Details and rates can change; the deal is made by phone, email or book-now, and is binding only with a signed rate confirmation.
- 2** Deadhead to origin / from destination. Too high = more loads, but more unpaid miles and hours.
- 3** Anywhere. Use zones: Z3 (and Z2).
- 4** Time since posted or refreshed. Old loads are often covered; fresh loads get booked quickly.
- 5** Creditworthiness from days-to-pay trends, collections, bankruptcies (via Equifax). DTP = average days to pay.
- 6** $\$1,800 \div 750 = \text{\$2.40}$ per total mile.
- 7** Brokers searching trucks (including for unposted freight) can find and call you.
- 8** Remove or update it immediately.
- 9** Can we haul it? Get there? Deliver it? Does it go somewhere good? Is it worth calling (rate, broker)?
- 10** A good outbound load into a dead market can lose money on the next leg. Knowing the reload options sets its real value.
- 11** Any three: bond backing, RMIS verification, factorable / new / private tags, rate insights, broker ratings.
- 12** Possible fraud or bait. Verify identity and authority carefully (Module 8), check with the factor, or skip it.

Three searches

#	Origin / DH-O	Destination / DH-D	Equipment	Type	Length / weight	Date
A	Newark, NJ · 50	Z0, Z1 (or blank, then filter)	Straight Box Truck + broad Van "Partial"	Full & partial	26 ft · 9,000 lb	Tomorrow
B	Salinas, CA · 50–75	Z7 (or Z8, Z7)	Reefer (R)	Full	53 ft · 43,000 lb	Fri
C	Birmingham, AL · 75	Z3, Z2	Flatbed (F), include FD	Full	48 ft · 46,000 lb	Today

Glossary

Age — Time since a posting was created or refreshed.

Alarm / alert — Notification when new matching loads appear.

Backhaul — Load that brings the truck back toward home or a good market.

Book now — Book online without a call; still produces a rate confirmation.

Credit score (CS) — DAT broker credit rating.

DH-O / DH-D — Deadhead to origin / from destination.

Days to pay (DTP) — Average payment time.

Factorable — Load whose invoice a factor will buy.

F / P — Full or partial load.

Load board — Online marketplace of loads and trucks.

Post a truck — Advertise available capacity.

Private loads — Loads visible only to selected carriers.

Rate per mile — Rate ÷ miles (loaded, or total including deadhead).

Reference ID — The broker's load number on the board.

Saved search — Stored search criteria for quick refresh.

Search back — Only show loads posted in the last X hours.

Trip — Loaded miles from pickup to delivery.

TriHaul — DAT tool suggesting triangular routes.

Zone — Region code (Z0–Z9) for searches.

Board codes you'll see (DAT)

Code	Meaning	Code	Meaning
V	Van (dry van)	F	Flatbed
VA	Van with air-ride	SD	Step deck
VM	Van with team	R	Reefer
VC	Van with curtains (curtaininside)	VR	Van or reefer: either can haul it
MV	Moving van	F / P	Full or partial load

Codes follow Module 2. Boards add and rename types; hover or open the equipment list on the board to confirm.

Sources

Source	What it supports	Where
DAT	How to search for loads (fields: origin, DH-O, destination, DH-D, load type, equipment, length, weight, dates, search back, company, private, book/bid)	one.support.dat.com
DAT	Understanding load details (trip, origin, date, load, truck, length, weight, commodity, reference ID, rate, rate/mile, market rates, company, credit score, days to pay)	one.support.dat.com
DAT	Credit Score FAQs (Equifax; days-to-pay trends, collections, bankruptcies)	iq.support.dat.com
DAT	Enable an alarm on your truck postings	one.support.dat.com
DAT	Complete Guide to Using the DAT Load Board (posting, search back, alerts, TriHaul)	dat.com
Truckstop	Searching for loads (requires active carrier authority); carrier onboarding (MFA, broker signals, rate insights, backhauls)	community.truckstop.com · truckstop.com
User-supplied	OMNITECH manual: DAT Power, TruckersEdge, 123Loadboard and Truckstop screenshots	your files



Practice board

All brokers on the practice board are fictional; distances are approximate; the \$2.40 minimum and Truck 12 details are practice values. Real rates come from live market data (Module 7).



Interfaces change

DAT One, Truckstop and other boards redesign screens and add features. Check the platform's help centre when something looks different.